

Holiday Readiness Capacity Review

November-December 2026 readiness | Owner: Ari Bell, Reliability Planning | Next review: 2026-09-07

Decision at a glance

Decision

Holiday capacity is feasible with a staged integrated rehearsal, a locked 35% reserve, and a December deployment freeze. The decision is deliberately cross-service: approval depends on end-to-end latency and settlement completion, not any single component graph.

Planning peak

10,800 transactions/min

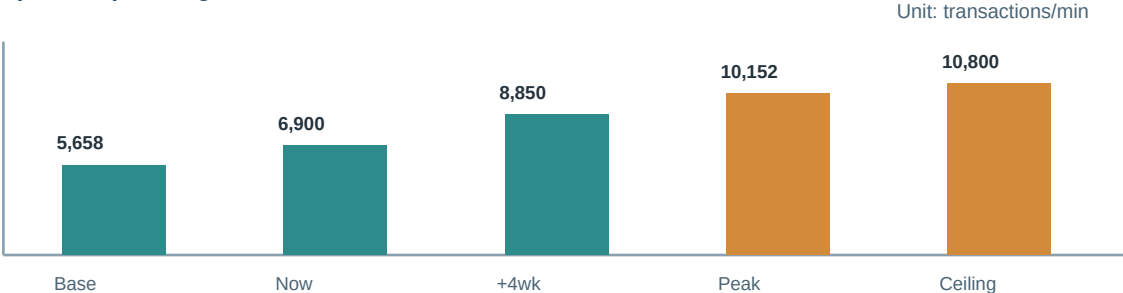
Evidence

Moderate; scenario combines commuter and event surges

Scope and assumptions

Holiday readiness combines fare purchase, account refresh, edge diversion, and settlement timing into a single operating scenario. It assumes 1.42 times ordinary peak demand, a 35% unallocated reserve, and a deployment freeze from 20 December. It excludes disaster recovery activation; that event uses a separate recovery plan.

Forecast profile - planning utilization



Capacity signals

Measure	Current	Planning limit	Decision signal
Scenario peak	6,900 transactions/min	10,800 transactions/min	Begin mitigation when rehearsal crosses 9,800.
Reserve after failover	37%	>= 35%	Do not approve campaign changes that consume the reserve.
End-to-end p95	410 ms	< 620 ms	Latency validates the combined dependency envelope.
Settlement completion	96.4%	>= 95.5%	Completion protects the post-peak recovery window.

Plan, controls, and ownership

Action plan

Action	Due	Owner	Acceptance evidence
Integrated rehearsal	Sep 12	Reliability Planning	Run purchase, identity, edge, and settlement together.
Freeze calendar	Oct 01	Change advisory	Publish the December deployment freeze.
Reserve lock	Nov 10	Capacity owners	Prevent nonessential allocation changes.
Readiness review	Dec 08	Ari Bell	Confirm service owners accept the final scenario.

Risk register

Risk	Likelihood	Impact	Response
Event and commuter overlap	Medium	High	Use staged entry and protect the 35% reserve.
Late configuration change	Medium	High	Require change advisory exception after freeze.
Cross-service contention	Medium	Medium	Use integrated rehearsal to find shared limits.

Decision rationale

Holiday capacity is feasible with a staged integrated rehearsal, a locked 35% reserve, and a December deployment freeze. The decision is deliberately cross-service: approval depends on end-to-end latency and settlement completion, not any single component graph.

Selective cross-references

Review alongside: Regional ingress headroom, Q3 checkout demand forecast, and Q3 identity capacity plan. These linked plans are relevant because they share a limiting dependency or coordinated operating window.

Model notes: all values are synthetic planning figures. No customer records, production identifiers, secrets, or routable network addresses are included. Northstar Transit Cloud | Seasonal readiness scenario